

## SH01 PROVIDE SICK LEAVE | O (MAX: 1 PT)

**Intent:** Improve recovery from and reduce transmission of diseases by enabling and encouraging employees to stay home when sick.

**Summary:** This feature requires projects to provide access to paid sick leave.

**Issue:** Access to basic healthcare services is one of five key pillars that form the social determinants of health.<sup>150</sup> Access includes physical or geographic access, affordability and quality or acceptability of care, and access varies based on race, ethnicity, socioeconomic status, age, sex, disability status, sexual orientation, gender identity and location.<sup>5,154,64,65</sup> While 94% of the world's countries mandate paid sick leave, the U.S. and Korea are the only OECD countries that do not, and 40% of American employees have no sick leave.<sup>155,156</sup> Studies estimate 20 million Americans and 37% of UK employees go to work sick because they lack sick leave or have only one-day sick leave, respectively, potentially infecting colleagues as a result.<sup>157,158</sup> Employees may also go into work when sick if their sick leave does not offer sufficient wage replacement.<sup>157</sup>

**Solutions:** Studies show implementing paid sick leave reduces contagion in the workplace, improves employee productivity and reduces employee turnover.<sup>157–161</sup> Overall, enhancing access to paid sick leave can help improve the physical, social and mental health of individuals and communities.<sup>151,153</sup>

### Part 1 Part 1 (Max: 1 Pt)

#### *For All Spaces:*

A sick leave policy that meets the following requirements is available to all eligible employees:

- a. Leave is offered up front or accrued for use during any 12-month period for any health condition and meets one of the following requirements:
  1. Short-term sick leave for all eligible employees, distinct from paid time off and family leave, at least 10 days of which are paid at 50% or higher of the employee's full salary or wages.
  2. At least 20 days of combined paid time off and sick leave which are paid at 50% or higher of the employee's full salary or wages.
- b. Statement that discourages employees from coming into work when they feel sick, and from doing work while on sick leave.
- c. At least one of the following:
  1. At least 12 weeks of sick leave (which may be unpaid) during any 12-month period for a chronic or serious health condition that involves inpatient care in a hospice or residential healthcare facility (e.g., stroke, infectious disease, surgery) or health condition that requires continuing treatment and/or supervision by a healthcare provider (e.g., diabetes, asthma, cancer).
  2. Part-time options, flexible schedules or permission to work from home when recovering from serious health conditions.